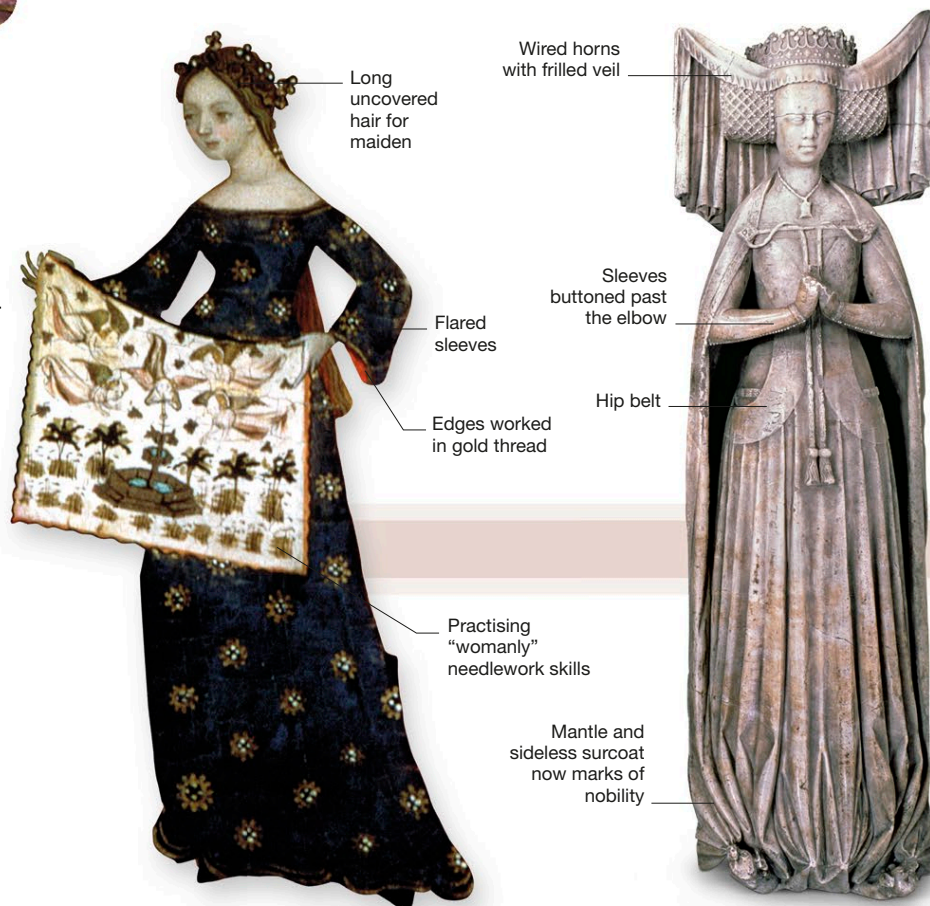


1380–1450

NOVELTY AND LUXURY

Many hallmarks of fashion were in place by the late 1400s: novelty, innovation, an element of impracticality, luxury, and – commentators insisted – excessive vanity and social presumption. Sumptuary laws still tried ineffectually to regulate who wore what. English and French headwear was fantastical, large, and varied. Italians were more natural; the Flemish preferred modest linen veils. Like men, women adopted the *houppelande* and other long, full pleated gowns cut from large, circular shapes, belted over a tight underdress that was buttoned or, increasingly, laced down the front. Their long, separate sleeves emerged from under the huge, open outer sleeves. Straight, scooped, or square necklines were low and shaped fashionably high round bosoms, sharply contrasting with the new high collars of outer clothing.



Long uncovered hair for maiden

Wired horns with frilled veil

Sleeves buttoned past the elbow

Flared sleeves

Hip belt

Edges worked in gold thread

Practising "womanly" needlework skills

Mantle and sideless surcoat now marks of nobility

Italo-Spanish dress Critics complained that necklines were so wide the breasts wanted to leave them. This dress from the 1390s has no belt, Italian style. The pearl-embroidered silk might have been woven locally in northern Italy.

English headpiece In 1417 a chronicler wrote of hats with "horns marvellously tall and broad, with long ears either side". The Countess of Arundel's effigy made in 1415 records this startling fashion.



High horned bun over temples and under frilled linen veil in layers

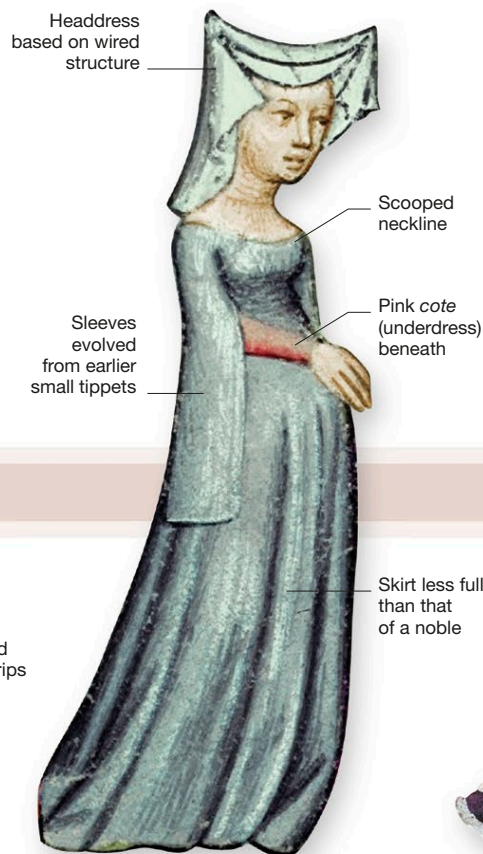
High, narrow belt

Finest fabric The bride in van Eyck's 1434 portrait wears Italian clothing for her wedding in Flanders. The bulk of the fur lining in her wool gown gives a fashionably prominent belly when lifted up.

Long sleeves weighed down with rows of strips dagged (decoratively cut) in cross shapes

Fur lining

Long hem of gown shows sheen of top-quality wool



Headdress based on wired structure

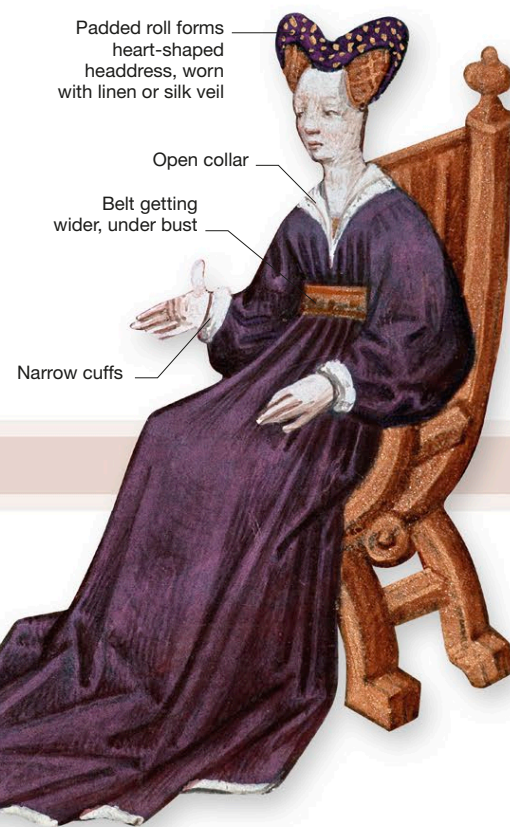
Scooped neckline

Pink cote (underdress) beneath

Sleeves evolved from earlier small tippets

Skirt less full than that of a noble

French cote-hardie This close-fitting outer gown has hanging but not excessive sleeves, and the fabric is plain. The linen veil over modest wired horns shows how normal women modified French court fashion around 1410.



Padded roll forms heart-shaped headdress, worn with linen or silk veil

Open collar

Belt getting wider, under bust

Narrow cuffs

Changing Burgundian styles From the 1430s the *robe* with narrow cuffs replaced the *houppelande*. The high collar, opened in the front and folded down, was the start of the V-neck popular later in the century.